

Drew

A gentleman who has seen the cycle before.



The dry observer

SPECIES

Flamingo

AGE

Mid-forties

PERSONALITY

- Composed, observant and quietly amused
- Dry rather than loud; knowing rather than smug
- Warm company, even when the verdict is merciless

He finds the absurdity in the system.

Background & place in the story

Drew is a successful, well-heeled gentleman with money, time and the calm of someone who has watched the same promises come around before. The Swinging Door gives him a familiar place to consider the news without surrendering his composure. He is a flamingo first, a gentleman second, and never a mascot.

He notices how an ordinary expense acquires an impressive new name. A headline supplies the occasion; Drew finds the mechanism underneath it. He does not need to win the argument or make anyone feel small. One precise observation, a slight lift of the eyebrow, and he can return to his martini.

Current portrait: 1024 x 1536 pixels, placed at approximately 287 PPI. No upscaling.

Signature details.

The small things that make this character unmistakable.

The black silk bow tie



His permanent identifying accessory: a clearly formed knot and two wings, sitting naturally above the V of his sleeveless sweater vest. It is part of his everyday character, not a costume change.

Feathers, never sleeves



Fine layered plumage continues from shoulder to fingertip. The vest armhole is the garment edge; a feathered forearm must not turn into a fabric sleeve or a smooth human arm.



A refined bill and a measured gaze

The long S-shaped neck, slender downward-curving black-tipped bill and composed eyes identify Drew at a glance. His expression stays approachable, not sinister.

Unretouched details from the current presentation portrait. Crops reveal existing marks; they do not add resolution.

In the conversation.

One speaker. Every listener knows who has the floor.



Speaking to Barclay

Bill open; gaze toward Barclay. The delivery stays restrained and conversational.



Listening to Barclay

Bill closed; attention across the counter toward Barclay, who has the line.



Listening to Abby

Bill closed; eyes lift toward Abby as she delivers the proprietor's verdict.

Facial acting crops from current Best Of masters, not retired concept sheets or newly invented full-body gestures.

How Drew speaks

- Use one clean, understandable observation.
- Let the comic turn come from a reclassification or a revealing comparison.
- Keep his delivery unhurried. He does not need a huge gesture to land a line.

Relationships

Barclay. Drew names the mechanism; Barclay supplies the receipt. Their two perspectives turn the same headline into a conversation rather than a lecture.

Abby. Her practical authority punctures his elegant theories. Drew is a regular in her room, not its master of ceremonies.

Keep consistent

- Frame-left, with his body clearly on the patron side of the marble.
- Martini in a conical stemmed glass: one olive on one pick.
- Feather-backed, articulated hands; no bare skin or mammal claws.
- The bill is open when he speaks and closed when he listens; his gaze stays inside the scene.

Barclay

He understands the headline. He also pays the bill.



The gentleman paying the bill

SPECIES

Golden retriever

AGE

Mid-forties

PERSONALITY

- Mature, self-assured and good-humored
- Practical about money without being cynical about people
- Soft-featured and approachable, never puppyish

He feels the absurdity in his wallet.

Background & place in the story

Barclay is a successful gentleman and unmistakably a golden retriever. He understands money, but experience has not made him immune to surprise at what things cost. The familiar company at The Swinging Door gives him room to say the practical thing everyone else is thinking.

He brings the news down to the scale of a household, a purchase or a receipt. The joke does not depend on making him foolish: his dignity is precisely what makes the observation land. His current expression is confident, happy and warm. Financial concerns may drive a line, but a sad or confused face is not his default.

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Signature details.

The small things that make this character unmistakable.

The American flag lapel pin



A permanent small flag on his left lapel, or left chest when he is not wearing a jacket. The dark canton and alternating stripes must remain recognizable in black and white; the pin is attached to the cloth, not floating above it.



A mature, warm retriever face

A black nose and dog lip line, softly freckled muzzle and expressive eyes with visible whites. Short natural crown fur and a modest neck ruff keep him groomed and upright, without a human hairstyle or an oversized neck beard.



Soft furry hands and a wristwatch

Broad, fur-backed hands articulate like hands: fingers and an opposed thumb, with soft fingertips and no visible nails or claws. A plain wristwatch and relaxed jacket complete the gentleman's silhouette.

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In the conversation.

One speaker. Every listener knows who has the floor.



Speaking to Drew

Mouth open; gaze toward Drew. His expression remains warm and assured.



Listening to Drew

Mouth closed; eyes on Drew, retaining the relaxed, mature face.



Listening to Abby

Mouth closed; attention lifts toward Abby while she has the last word.

Facial acting crops from current Best Of masters, not retired concept sheets or newly invented full-body gestures.

How Barclay speaks

- Speak from his own experience or wallet.
- Prefer a concrete purchase, bill or everyday consequence to financial jargon.
- Let him be candid and dignified at the same time.

Relationships

Drew. Drew sees the system; Barclay feels its consequences in his wallet. Neither is the other's fool. Their friendship gives the joke a human scale.

Abby. He respects the owner of the room. Her matter-of-fact answer can settle a debate that even his most sensible question could not.

Keep consistent

- Frame-right; seated upright with believable clearance from the bar.
- Dark jacket over a pale open-collared shirt, without a tie.
- Old fashioned in a short rocks glass, with one large cube and a dark cherry.
- Flag pin retained, both hands accounted for, and no tail.
- Mouth open for his line; closed when listening, with his eyes on the speaker.

Abby

It is her bar, even when she is out of the frame.



The proprietor with the last word

SPECIES

West Highland terrier

AGE

Mid-forties

PERSONALITY

- Warm, quick-witted and entirely in command
- Elegant and feminine, without a frightening or exaggerated expression
- An attentive proprietor whose welcome has standards

She settles the absurdity from behind the bar.

Background & place in the story

Abby owns The Swinging Door and works its bar. She is the proprietor, not background scenery or somebody else's employee. The welcome, the standards and the rhythm of the room are hers. She is fond of the gentlemen, values their conversation and is intimidated by neither of them.

While Drew notices the mechanism and Barclay considers the bill, Abby keeps a real business running. That practical viewpoint gives her the authority to close the conversation with one warm, decisive line. She need not appear in every cartoon for the room to feel like hers; when she joins the exchange, her contribution matters.

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Signature details.

The small things that make this character unmistakable.



The studded collar and teardrop

One even row of rounded studs, a front buckle and one teardrop pendant. This is her signature accessory; the retired pearl-necklace design is not the current Abby.



One empty glass, one plain towel

Her current work action is polishing an empty wine glass. One hand supports the glass while the other works the towel. No liquid, no duplicate towel on the shoulder and no lettering on the cloth.



Soft terrier fur and capable hands

Short, fine mammal fur covers the forearms and hands, never feather shapes. Her fingers have a believable grip. Welcoming eyes, a proportional head and a fitted blouse complete the current character.

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In the conversation.

One speaker. Every listener knows who has the floor.



Delivering the last word

Mouth open; attention toward the gentlemen, with the glass-polishing action retained.



Listening to Drew

Mouth closed; face and eyes turn toward Drew while her hands stay at their work.



Listening to Barclay

Mouth closed; attention shifts to Barclay. She remains the host of the room.

Facial acting crops from current Best Of masters, not retired concept sheets or newly invented full-body gestures.

How Abby speaks

- Speak with authority, delivered warmly.
- A proprietor's decision or practical rule makes a natural comic ending.
- She may address them as gentlemen; her line settles the matter rather than begging for agreement.

Relationships

Drew. She hears his polished observations without being overawed by them. Her practical answer brings the conversation back to the counter.

Barclay. She understands his wallet-level concerns, but she also knows what it takes to keep the lights on. Affection never makes her surrender the last word.

Keep consistent

- Behind the bar on the service side, standing higher than the seated gentlemen.
- A fitted light blouse with rolled sleeves, a dark skirt and no tail.
- A small proportional West Highland terrier head with bright, welcoming eyes.
- A plain towel in exactly one place, actively polishing an empty wine glass.
- Mouth open for her line; otherwise closed, looking at Drew or Barclay rather than the reader.